

Annotated Bibliography for Intergroup Interaction in Overcoming Prejudice

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Introduction

Many psychologists have become increasingly concerned about the role of prejudice and its effects on interracial contact in a wide array of settings. The purpose of this paper is to review 8 such articles and their settings. We will see how these researchers have chosen to conduct their experiments. We will look at their methods, and how all tie into our hypothesis.

The willingness of the Finnish to welcome immigrants from Russia and its positive impact on reducing realistic and symbolic threats was explored in multiple longitudinal studies by Mahonen and Jasinskaja-Lahti. Their research investigated how the perceived contact willingness of the Finnish population affected the adaptation of Russian immigrants to Finnish culture. The findings indicated a reduction in perceived threats and improved integration outcomes for the immigrants (Mahonen & Jasinskaja-Lahti, 2016).

It is essential for countries to have action plans that facilitate the comfortable reception and adaptation of immigrants to preexisting cultures. Such plans can mitigate threats faced by both the host country and the immigrants. These initiatives should not solely depend on the proactive efforts of newcomers but should also involve a concerted push from locals willing to engage positively with immigrants (Mahonen & Jasinskaja-Lahti, 2016). Additional research is recommended to explore variables such as unemployment and job insecurity and their impact on intergroup contact.

The effects of indirect and vicarious intergroup contact on relationships and prejudice reduction were examined in Germany. An initial experiment with 48 applied sciences students from a German university tested intergroup affect and willingness to contact outgroup members. Positive interactions were shown to influence intergroup affect positively. A subsequent

experiment with 53 participants confirmed the consistency of these findings, with equivalent results on the role of vicarious contact and cross group contact (Mazziotta et al, 2011).

Pettigrew and Tropp (2006) conducted a comprehensive meta-analysis of 515 studies to validate George Allport's hypothesis that collective resources and goals reduce prejudice among ethnic groups. They examined optimal conditions across 134 samples, finding that increased intergroup contact correlates with reduced prejudice and better intergroup relations. Their meticulous approach included analyzing study types, contact measurements, control groups, and quality measures, confirming the effectiveness of Allport's conditions in diminishing prejudice.

Shelton and Richeson (2005) investigated how pluralistic ignorance affects interactions between white and black students. Their study revealed that each group underestimated the other's willingness to interact, primarily due to fears of rejection and prejudice. The researchers also looked at intergroup contact willingness through a friend familiar with both groups and concluded that this balanced perspective shifted their anxieties of acceptance into the other group. This research suggests that while there is a desire for interaction across groups, societal and racial differences pose significant barriers, which can be mitigated through trusted perspectives and positive interactions.

The use of virtual reality to study positive interracial contact was explored in Finland and Italy, focusing on racial discrimination against individuals of African descent. Researchers tested Allport's optimal conditions across two studies with distinct settings, cooperative and competitive gaming. Testing the implicit and explicit measures of outgroup attitudes, and emotional mediators through the virtual program common cyber identity. Findings supported the hypothesis that cooperation with a black avatar in VR settings improves intergroup attitudes for white people (Tassinari et al, 2015).

Linda Tropp's (2007) research on interracial contact and positive feelings between minority and majority groups used data from the Taking America's Pulse survey. She gathered data from the survey to form a sample group of 995 white Americans and 709 black Americans, both non-Hispanic. The research shows that in both interracial contact and interracial closeness both blacks and whites reported similarly low numbers, with black Americans having weaker contact and closeness. When black Americans were asked if they felt discrimination in the American society today, they reported much higher perceived discrimination than white Americans. This perceived discrimination greatly hindered the blacks' desire to form close contact with whites. Tropp highlights that perceived discrimination hinders close contact between blacks and whites. However, interracial friendships were found to reduce the influence of perceived discrimination on attitudes towards intergroup relationships.

Van Laar, Levin, Sinclair, and Sidanius (2005) gathered white, Latino, African American, and Asian American students and studied their contact willingness and racial prejudice. Their study found a reduction in racial prejudice through increased contact among roommates of different ethnic backgrounds. In addition, revealing that choosing to live with a person of another race humanizes them and breaks down prejudicial barriers and was shown to be the most effective form of racial prejudice reduction. Positive feelings and mutual respect increased among students living with roommates from different ethnic groups (Van Laar et al, 2005).

In Australia, researchers tested the effect of adolescent friendships on reducing prejudice towards Asian and Arab Australians. The study hypothesized that stronger friendships would predict lower levels of prejudice. They studied subtle and blatant forms of prejudice in both high-school aged adolescents and university-aged adolescents. Concluding that those who had friends

of another ethnic and racial origin had greatly reduced their feelings of prejudice towards that racial group. The researchers indicated that interracial social contact reduces both blatant and subtle prejudices, with lower reports of blatant prejudice (White et al, 2009).

Conclusion

The purpose of this study is to examine different approaches of intergroup contact in reducing prejudice. The studies reviewed demonstrate the positive outcomes of increased intergroup contact, including reduced prejudice and improved relations. This body of research underscores the importance of fostering environments that encourage positive interactions between groups to mitigate threats and enhance social wellness. I hypothesize that the more one has in common socially with a member of a racial/ethnic outgroup the more willing someone will be to engage in contact with that outgroup (or individual of the outgroup).

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